VIDEO ANALYSIS CASE STUDY · BIAN LUOTAO

G A P

How a cut makes a relationship visible



05:38 · The reverse angle brings both characters into a shared frame.

05:36:16 — movement becomes meaning

A cut during Gao Chen’s rise changes both the camera angle and the way the two characters occupy the frame. It is the clearest example in this case study of editing doing narrative work.

THE FILM	MY CONTRIBUTION	THIS CASE STUDY
2022 · short fiction	Writing and directing	Selected visual cases
9:14 including credits	Editing, colour, sound post	Technical delivery checks

Original post-production completed in DaVinci Resolve. All film images shown here come from the final master; the black bars are removed for presentation, with no additional colour grade.

Portfolio | **Analysis reel** | **Full film**

Jiaxing, Zhejiang, China (UTC+8) · luotaobian@gmail.com

01 · CONTEXT

The filmmaker and the film

Bian Luotao

Based in Jiaxing, China. I wrote and directed *G A P*, then edited, graded and completed its sound post in DaVinci Resolve. I currently work in textile export and am seeking part-time remote video-evaluation work in the evenings and at weekends (UTC+8).

BACKGROUND	DETAIL
Post-production	DaVinci Resolve Edit, Color and Fairlight; Fusion at a basic level.
Education	University of Essex, UK (Sep 2024–Sep 2025): film-related undergraduate study; no degree awarded. Kaplan International College London (2023–2024): Foundation Certificate for Business, Law and Social Sciences; completed. High school, China: completed.
Language	Chinese: native. English: previous IELTS overall score of 6.0.

A story about what people conceal

The film follows a young worker, Wang Liang, his boyfriend Gao Chen and his father, a delivery rider. Workplace humiliation and a strained family relationship converge around a confrontation in a noodle shop. The visual approach often keeps a face, reaction or source of pressure outside the frame.



05:58 · Frosted glass and the seated manager establish a visible hierarchy.

Contribution and evidence

My signed screenplay drafts document the writing, and the end credits list me as director. I did the editing, colour grading and sound post myself; these roles are not listed individually in the end credits. Cinematography, location sound and lighting belong to the credited crew.

Two ways to reveal a relationship

01 A cut that changes the relationship



05:33 · One character is partly hidden.



05:38 · Both share the reverse angle.

Observation · 05:36:16. The cut lands as Gao Chen rises. The following angle shows the two from behind, with his hand on Wang Liang's back.

Reading. Movement carries attention across the cut while the new framing makes physical support visible. The interpretation comes from the change in bodies and space; it does not require a claim about the unseen editing process.

Trade-off. Before the cut, Gao Chen is partly obscured, so some of his reactions are difficult to see.

02 One doorway, two occupants



03:18 · Wang Liang in the doorway.



03:31 · His father occupies the frame.

Observation · 03:01–03:32. A static doorway composition passes from son to father without a cut between their appearances.

Reading. Holding the frame invites comparison between the two people. The empty interval can convey hesitation, while the dark face remains a visibility concern.

The frame can hold power off-screen

03 Hierarchy through obstruction



05:58 · The father stands; the manager sits.

Observation · 05:52–06:16. Frosted glass hides the standing father's head while the seated manager remains visible.

Reading and cost. The height difference and obstruction communicate unequal status. They also withhold the father's facial reaction, so the viewer must rely more on posture and context.

04 Staying with the person under pressure



06:33 · The camera holds on Wang Liang.



06:49 · A hand enters the shared frame.

Observation · 06:30–06:56. The scene holds on Wang Liang looking down at his food. Later, an aggressor is represented by a hand entering the two-person composition.

Reading. The framing prioritises the targets' responses over a complete view of the aggressor. It is an example of selective visual information, not proof that every unseen event is clear.

Where information becomes hard to read

05 The discovery remains in a soft background



02:53 · Once the shot settles on the father, the background interaction stays soft.

Observation · approximately 02:48–02:54. Focus favours the father's profile; the background interaction does not become comparably clear in the checked passage.

Risk. A first-time viewer may struggle to identify exactly what he notices. Context and the following scene may still supply that information; softness alone does not prove narrative failure.

Production option. If direct recognition is essential, a focus pull or a brief point-of-view insert would give more evidence. A finished master cannot recover detail that was never recorded.

06 Rotation competes with the rescue action



08:06 · The helmet remains near a rotating view.



08:14 · A stable view shows the aftermath.

Observation · 08:03–08:12. Rotation and fragments of bodies make the protective action difficult to identify in the checked frames. The image does not establish how the camera was mounted.

With this master: shorten the rotation and reach the aftermath earlier. **For a reshoot:** add a stable view of the decisive action and the son's response. The first option changes pacing; it cannot supply missing coverage.

Reading colour and delivery data

Separate image content from production choices



03:18 · A dark face against dark surroundings.



02:53 · A warmer passage at the pick-up window.

The doorway frame has limited separation between the face and surrounding shadows. The pick-up-window passage is visibly warmer. These observations describe the final image; the master alone cannot separate lighting, camera settings and colour-grading decisions.

MEASUREMENT	WHAT IT CAN SUPPORT	WHAT IT CANNOT PROVE
Whole-frame luma	A description of overall brightness in sampled frames.	The exposure or readability of one face.
Luma percentiles	Where a proportion of pixel values falls.	The brightest pixel or a clipped highlight.
Chroma / colour distribution	A comparison of sampled image content.	A specific grading operation or an unintended cast.

Audio stream structure

The master contains two separate mono audio streams. The second has non-zero signal in two night exteriors, around 02:08 and 02:54. Its intended routing is not established.

Next technical check. Compare the contents and intended routing of both streams, then test how the target player selects or combines them. Choose the delivery mix only after that check.

Stream structure is a file-level finding. Listening and physical-device playback are separate verification steps, described in the method on page 8.

Subtitle QA: precise, local corrections

Burned-in text is part of the final image. Selected examples below separate visible English errors from translation questions that require the spoken Chinese.

TIME	VISIBLE TEXT	PROPOSED CORRECTION / SCOPE
01:03	Bloodyhell! How come they are here so early!	“Bloody hell!” needs a space. Choice of dialect is a localisation decision, not automatically an error.
03:13	How could you be with a guy.	Use a question mark: “How could you be with a guy?”
05:22	I thought everything will be fine if we mind ous own business.	“I thought we’d be fine if we minded our own business.” Corrects spelling and tense sequence.
06:00	How many times you were late?	“How many times were you late?” fixes question word order. “How many times have you been late?” is a context-dependent alternative for a period extending to the present.

Meaning needs the original dialogue



08:23 · “Mom always knows!” appears in the final image.

The screenplay suggests a retrospective meaning: “Mom has known all along.” That is a candidate translation, not a final correction until the line is checked against the recorded dialogue.

Reading speed and coverage

A useful workflow is to log each subtitle’s first and last visible frames, count characters consistently, flag fast cards, then read them during normal playback. A platform-specific threshold is a screening aid, not a universal quality rule. Complete dialogue coverage and translation accuracy are not claimed here.

From film observation to video evaluation

Evidence, impact and response

FIELD	EXAMPLE
Clip / dimension	G A P, 08:03–08:12 · action legibility
Observed evidence	The view rotates; body fragments are visible, while the precise protective action is hard to identify in the checked frames.
Impact / confidence	Potential loss of story information. Confidence is limited by the frame-based review; assess normal-speed playback before a final severity rating.
Style / defect distinction	Rotation is visible. Whether it is intended and whether it serves the story are separate questions.
Response	Shorten the rotation using the master; add stable coverage only in a reshoot.

What carries over to generated video

Check requested action, identity and object continuity, camera movement, timing, image legibility and on-screen text separately. Name the visible evidence and its time range. Distinguish a stylistic choice from a failure to provide the requested information, and use the employer’s rubric before assigning a numerical score.

Method and authorship

AI assistance was used for frame sampling, technical measurements, analysis drafts, portfolio editing and layout. I wrote and directed the film with a credited crew, and did its original editing, colour grade and sound post myself. This case study is a later, AI-assisted presentation of that work.

The case study uses sampled frames, close checks of selected transitions and file-level measurements from the final master. Continuous listening review, full subtitle-to-dialogue verification and physical-device playback tests are outside the completed checks. Sound observations are limited to stream structure; interpretive claims are identified as such.

I no longer have the original camera media or the Resolve project. This is a final-master case study, not a before/after grading demonstration. Timecodes count from the first frame of the film; frame-qualified timecodes use 24 fps.

Watch the work

Portfolio | **Analysis reel** | **Full film**

https://luotaobian.github.io/gap-portfolio/

Team credits: producer Guo Qiancheng; cinematography Yu Yin; location sound Lai Chengxi; lighting Meng Wei. I do not claim these crew roles.

Bian Luotao · Jiaxing, Zhejiang, China (UTC+8) · luotaobian@gmail.com
Part-time availability: evenings and weekends, UTC+8.